Tin Shotti তিন সত্যি – a one-tap child mode for the parent's own phone

Abraar Masud Nafiz · Junior PM assessment, Nagorik Technologies · 4 Nov 2026

Tags: [1] checked source (list at end) · ASSUMPTION not verified · BET 1-3 decides go or stop

In one line: when a parent hands their Android phone to a 3–8-year-old, Tin Shotti lets only the apps the parent picked open (YouTube Kids by default), shows the time left as a light round the screen edge, and ends the session kindly. Calls and 999 always work. Setup takes about 3 minutes, in Bangla.

1 Choose the problem

The situation. Evening. A 3–8-year-old asks for Ammu's or Abbu's Android phone "to watch rhymes on YouTube". Autoplay drifts from learning videos to anything, taking the phone back ends in an argument, and the phone holds the parent's WhatsApp and Facebook.

Why this first.

- One moment, the handover, holds three of the four comments: what they watch next, the evening argument, the hard setup.
- Free tools fit it badly. Family Link needs the child's own Google Account[3]; YouTube Kids' limits work only inside YouTube Kids[2]; app pinning holds one app[4]; kid modes are one brand each[10,15]; Android 16's Parental controls are for the child's own device[14].
- Children this young can't negotiate limits, so a rule the phone applies the same way every evening should help most. ASSUMPTION

9–14-year-olds: later, on purpose. Most have their own phone, where Family Link fits[3]; on a shared phone they get one or two extra apps (school, reading).

One assumption that could make this wrong: most 3–8-year-olds watch on a parent's shared Android phone, not a tablet or the TV. ASSUMPTION The landing page (section 4) asks every visitor.

2 Define the MVP (one Android developer, six weeks)

What it does	Why
1. One-tap handover with allowed apps. The parent taps *Give to child*. Only allowed apps open (YouTube Kids by default); any other app gets a friendly "grown-up app" cover. Incoming calls and 999 always work[13]; a WhatsApp call needs the parent's PIN.	Keeps "what they watch next" in a filtered app and the child out of WhatsApp. YouTube Kids filters, free, in Bangladesh[1]; we don't. Children must accept it instead of YouTube. ASSUMPTION
2. Time the child can see, and a kind ending. Daily minutes (optionally only 6–10 pm). A light grows round the screen edge, with no numbers. Then a voice, confetti and "Well done"; extra time has a fixed limit (step 6).	The phone says "stop" the same way every evening, so there is less to argue about. Light and voice because many 3–5-year-olds can't read. BET 1
3. A 3-minute guided setup in Bangla. Pictures for the phone's brand (Xiaomi, Realme, Tecno, Samsung…) and a *Test it now* check.	Answers "setting it up was too difficult": the main thing the free route lacks.

Two things I would leave out. (1) **Our own video filter**: YouTube Kids already filters, and one miss would destroy trust. (2) **A remote parent dashboard**: it needs accounts, a backend and child data.

Riskiest technical assumption. BET 2 A normal Play Store app, without device-owner rights, can keep a child inside the allowed apps. Evidence points the other way: without those rights Android offers only screen pinning, which the user can leave[4], and battery savers on Xiaomi and Samsung kill background apps[5].

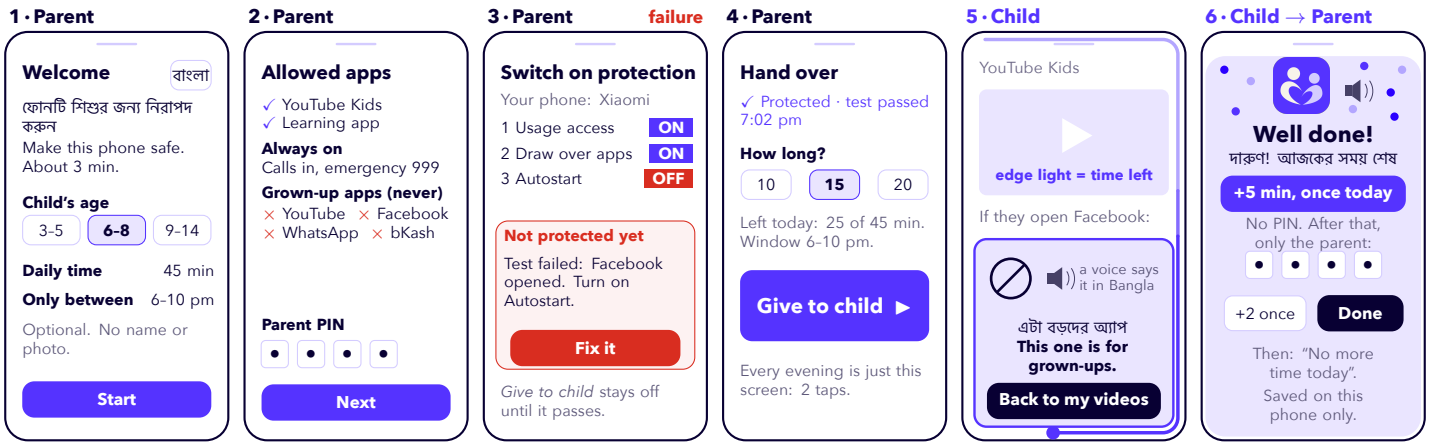
What I would ask the developer (a 3-day spike in week 1):

(a) On four low-cost phones (Android 10–15), *Usage access* + overlay vs an Accessibility service[12]: is a blocked app covered within a second, does the guard last 45 min on battery saver, and do calls and 999 still work?
(b) Which escapes would a 7-year-old find (notification shade, recent apps, split screen, restart)?
(c) What Play review needs (`isMonitoringTool`[8], foreground service) and how long it takes.

Plan with one gate. Wk 1: spike and Figma prototype. Wk 2: payment test (section 4); the developer builds setup and timer, needed in any version. **End of wk 2:** guard and test pass → build the guard (wks 3–4). Guard fails → ship a guided setup of the free tools, free (reason 2 in section 4 is gone), and re-test pricing. Test fails → stop. Wk 3: an internal Play build clears the policy declarations early. Wk 5: closed test, 15 families. Wk 6: launch from Nagorik's Play account, which skips the new-account testing rule[9] ASSUMPTION. AI speeds up screens, not testing on real phones.

3 Show the experience (sketches at the top of page 2; Bangla first)

- **Parent does:** steps 1–4 once (3 minutes), then step 4 each evening. **Child sees:** steps 5–6.
- **Failure and how it's handled (step 3):** the battery saver kills the guard, or a permission is off. The app tests the guard before every handover; on a fail the parent sees *Not protected yet* with the fix for their phone, and *Give to child* stays off. A guard that dies mid-session is reported at the next handover.
- **Privacy and trust decision:** Tin Shotti reads only *which app* is in front, never the screen or the videos. No child account, name or photo; history stays on the phone, and only the counts in section 5 leave it. The child always sees the light: open rules, not secret watching.
- **First useful result:** the first evening that ends on time on the phone's word, not the parent's.



4 Explain why someone would pay

Why not the free option? They exist: YouTube Kids[2], app pinning[4], Digital Wellbeing timers[11], brand kid modes[10,15], Android 16's Parental controls[14] (rare on low-cost phones here ASSUMPTION). Google shipping more is the real risk. A parent pays for what they lack on a shared phone:

1. **Setup they can finish:** one Bangla flow with steps for their phone's brand, not several settings menus.
2. **One rule for the whole phone, on any brand:** the free limits work inside one app[2,11] or on one brand[10,15]. I bet few parents find the kid modes ASSUMPTION; the landing page asks.
3. **A calmer evening:** the same visible ending every day. ASSUMPTION until the week-5 closed test.

Price: BDT 99 a month after a 14-day free trial; under BDT 100 keeps it a small decision. BET 3 Subscriptions must use Google Play billing[7]. Google's payment-methods page doesn't list Bangladesh, which means cards only[16]; some third-party guides say bKash works. Week 1: try bKash and carrier billing on a Bangladeshi account. If neither works, sell through a telco or MFS bundle (Nagorik works with both).

Test before building (week 2; BDT 5,000 of ads, about 500 visitors ASSUMPTION): a Bangla landing page with a 40-second prototype video, shared in parent Facebook groups. One tap first: "Which device does your 3–8-year-old use most?" Then: "Reserve the founding price: pay BDT 99 by bKash, refunded on request or if we don't launch." It measures intent: an upper bound.

Pass: 2% or more pay (about 10 of 500). **Reconsider if** under 0.5% pay, or most say "YouTube Kids or Samsung Kids is enough": go free with a telco or school bundle, or pick another problem. In between: retest the message, or BDT 49. 500 visitors only separate a clear yes from a clear no; thresholds are guesses, set in advance.

5 Measure success

Outcome: week-2 return rate. Of families who finish setup in launch week, the share who start 3+ child sessions in week 2. Three evenings mean the routine took hold.

How: counts per random install ID (setup finished; session started; how it ended: on time, after +5 or +2, early, window closed) through Firebase Analytics with the advertising ID off: no backend, no child data, no app names ASSUMPTION. Aim for 100+ setups and 10 short calls. With about 100 families the rate is good to only ±10 points, so the bands are wide on purpose.

Decision (set before launch): **40% or more: continue** and switch on the paywall; day-15 trial-to-paid is the next check (under 5%: back to section 4). **20–40%: change**: call 10 families who stopped; fix setup and phone-brand failures first. **Under 20%: stop** features; revisit the problem. **Guard on** BET 1**:** if the parent gives +2 or adds time on more than half of week-2 evenings, the ending isn't working: "change", whatever the return rate.

6 Also

Rejected alternative: our own "approved videos only" player on embedded YouTube. YouTube's API policies forbid charging to watch embedded videos and blocking the player's links[6], and YouTube Kids already does it, free.

Biggest unanswered question: does a timer the phone enforces end the argument, or does the child fight the phone after their +5 and the parent give in every night? The week-5 closed test and the +2 guard answer it.

Sources (official pages unless noted; checked 3–4 Nov 2026; names are links): **1** YouTube Kids Help 6130573 (lists Bangladesh) · **2** YouTube Kids Help 6172308, 6130558 · **3** Google For Families 9116646 · **4** Android, "Lock task mode"; Android Help 9455138 · **5** dontkillmyapp.com (community) · **6** YouTube API Policies §III.F.3, §III.I.4 · **7** Play Console 9858738 · **8** Play Console 12955211 · **9** Play Console 14151465 · **10** Samsung Kids (BD); Samsung support · **11** Android Help 9346420 · **12** Play Console 10964491 · **13** The Daily Star, "For emergency, dial 999" (news) · **14** Android parental controls · **15** realme Kid Space · **16** Google Play Help 2651410 (Bangladesh not listed: cards only; rechecked 4 Nov). I talked informally with a few parents I know. That is not research, so every claim about parents stays an assumption.

AI use and my time: about 80 minutes of my own time over two days, thinking, reviewing and deciding, while Claude agents (Claude Code) worked in parallel. A research agent found the sources; I checked each claim against its page and marked the rest ASSUMPTION. I made the calls on problem, cuts, price, thresholds and timer rules. Claude drafted the screens, Bangla copy, layout and the optional **working notes** (diagrams, test cases, PRD) and critiqued each draft; I kept what held up (missed free competitors, payment test before the build) and rejected the rest.